

Magnus Eldrup

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Public Economics; Development Economics; Taxation and Informality

EDUCATION

University of Copenhagen 2023–present
PhD in Economics. Advisors: Niels Johannesen and John Rand.

University of Oxford 2022–2023
MSc Economics for Development, **Double Distinction**.
Joint recipient of the Luca D’Agliano Prize for **Best Dissertation**.

University of Copenhagen 2022–2023
Master’s degree in Economics, **GPA 12/12**.

University of Copenhagen 2018–2021
Bachelor’s degree in Economics, **GPA 11.5/12, highest in cohort**.
Danish Central Bank award for **best Bachelor’s thesis** in Economics.

University of California, Berkeley Spring 2020
Exchange semester in Economics, **GPA 4.0/4.0**.

VISITING APPOINTMENT

Harvard Kennedy School Sep 2025–Jan 2026
Visiting PhD Fellow, Center for International Development.

RESEARCH

JOB MARKET PAPER

Horizontal Inequality in Optimal Taxation: Evidence from a Development Context
Single-authored. CEBI Working Paper 19/26, 2026.
Presented at CSAE 2026, Kiel–CEPR African Economic Development Conference 2025, and NPPS 2025.

WORKING PAPERS AND ONGOING RESEARCH

Optimal Enforcement of Redistributive Taxation
with Claus Thustrup Kreiner.
Presented at the CEPR Public Economics Annual Symposium 2026, CESifo Public Economics Conference 2025, and IIPF 2025.

The Limits of VAT Neutrality: Theory and Evidence from Kenya
with Cyrus Mutuku and Bjørn Bo Sørensen.
Theory and evidence on VAT refund apportionment and firm production responses to Kenya’s 2019 reform.

Can AI Predict Top Five? Gender Bias in LLM Forecasts of Academic Excellence
with Paolo Falco and Sarah Zaccagni. Working paper, 2026.
Preregistered evaluation of LLM forecasts using 1,626 economics papers.

A Worker’s Worth
with Paolo Falco and Andreas Menzel.
IGC grant ETH-24324; fieldwork in progress.

POLICY RESEARCH

Reforming Excise Taxation on Alcohol Products in Kenya and Reforming Excise Taxation on Tobacco Products in Kenya
with Alex Oguso, James Ochieng’, Nathan Remcho, and Hellen Chemnyongoi.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- **Fulbright Commission Grantee**, visiting fellowship at Harvard Kennedy School, 2025–26.
- **International Growth Centre (IGC) grant ETH-24324**, for *A Worker's Worth* (with Paolo Falco and Andreas Menzel).
- **STEG PhD Research Grant**, Structural Transformation and Economic Growth (STEG).
- **Luca D'Agliano Prize for Best Dissertation**, MSc Economics for Development, University of Oxford, 2023 (joint recipient).
- **Danish Central Bank Bachelor's Thesis Award**, 2021.
- **UCPH Economics Department Covid-19 Essay Competition**, award recipient.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2026 CSAE Conference; Aarhus University, Department of Economics and Business Economics; NCDE Conference.

2025 CESifo Public Economics Conference; Kiel–CEPR African Economic Development Conference; NPPS Conference.

TEACHING AND MENTORING

University of Copenhagen

Sep 2019–present

Teaching Assistant

- Courses: Introduction to Microeconomics; Economics in Society; Applied Research Methods; Advanced Development Microeconomics.
- Teaching includes exercise classes, feedback on assignments, and supervision of independent student projects.

University of Copenhagen

Aug 2024–present

Special Educational Support (SPS) mentor for an economics student.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Economists Without Borders

Sep 2021–Aug 2022

Volunteer / Project Lead. Conducted employment-benefit analysis and managed a social-return-on-investment project.

Videokompagniet ApS

Jul 2017–Aug 2022

Co-Founder.

Coffee for a Better Future, Danida project, Kenya

Oct 2016–Mar 2017

Technical Supervisor. Planned and supervised development and deployment of a coffee traceability system for local farmers.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming: Stata (advanced); Python (advanced); MATLAB (intermediate).

Languages: Danish and English (fluent); French and Somali (basic).

MEDIA AND OUTREACH

Dagbladet Information: comment on climate-tied development aid (Danish).

Departmental training on the use of AI in research, University of Copenhagen.